

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp *****

TUESDAY, JANUARY 7, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXV NO. 5

WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 42706.56 ▼ 25.57 0.06% NASDAQ 19864.98 ▲ 1.2% STOXX 600 513.02 ▲ 1.0% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 5/32, yield 4.616% OIL \$73.56 ▼ \$0.40 GOLD \$2,638.40 ▼ \$6.60 EURO \$1.0391 YEN 157.65

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **The U.S. economy** added more than two million jobs over the past year, but more people who are out of work are having a hard time finding new positions. **A1**

◆ **The Fed's top** supervisory official said he would step down, avoiding a potential legal fight with the incoming Trump administration. **A2**

◆ **U.S. stocks ended mixed**, with the S&P 500 and Nasdaq advancing 0.6% and 1.2%, respectively, and the Dow industrials retreating 0.1%. **B1**

◆ **U.S. Steel and Nippon Steel** filed lawsuits accusing Biden, the president of the steelworkers union and the CEO of a rival company of conspiring to scuttle their \$14.1 billion tie-up. **A2**

◆ **Meta Platforms said** UFC President Dana White joined its board of directors, along with Exor CEO John Elkann and tech investor Charlie Songhurst. **B3**

◆ **Smithfield filed for an** initial public offering, a move that would again take the pork producer public in the U.S. after it was acquired by China's WH Group in 2013. **B3**

◆ **Arcelor-Mittal South Africa** will wind down its long-steel-products business after weak economic conditions, high costs and Chinese steel imports weighed on the company. **B4**

◆ **Foxconn posted** record revenue for the fourth quarter, helped by robust demand for servers to power burgeoning artificial-intelligence technologies. **B3**

◆ **Ulta said Kecia Steelman** will succeed David Kimbell as chief executive, as the company aims to reaccelerate its sales amid a global slowdown in the beauty market. **B4**

World-Wide

◆ **Congress quickly** and smoothly certified President-elect Trump's election victory, a sharp contrast to four years earlier, when a pro-Trump mob stormed the Capitol and temporarily halted the confirmation of President Biden. **A1, A4**

◆ **Prime Minister Trudeau** said he would resign, making him the latest global progressive leader to fall from power and leaving Canada rudderless as it prepares to contend with Trump's threats to upend free trade in North America. **A1**

◆ **Trump attempted** to block his hush-money sentencing, arguing that the trial judge wrongly scheduled it before the president-elect's return to the White House. **A4**

◆ **Iranian forces have** largely withdrawn from Syria following the Assad regime's collapse, U.S., European and Arab officials said, in a blow to Tehran's strategy for projecting power in the Middle East. **A6**

◆ **A Chinese-owned vessel** cut an undersea fiber-optic cable near Taiwan, Taiwanese authorities said, causing minimal service disruption but underlining the vulnerability of the island and its internet. **A9**

◆ **North Korea carried out** an intermediate-range missile test, ending a nearly two-month hiatus in weapons trials and signaling a reluctance to return to diplomacy with the U.S. **A9**

◆ **Austria's Freedom Party** was tasked with trying to form what could become the nation's first far-right-led government since World War II, adding to the trend of anti-immigrant and populist parties gaining ground across Europe. **A7**

CONTENTS Markets Digest... B7
Arts in Review... A13
Business & Finance B2
Business News... B3
Crossword... A13
Heard on Street... B10
Markets and Finance B9

Opinion... A15-17
Personal Journal A11-12
Sports... A14
Technology... B4
U.S. News... A2-5
World News... A6-10



© 2025 Dow Jones & Company, Inc.
All Rights Reserved



Vice President Kamala Harris, at the side of House Speaker Mike Johnson, had the duty Monday of announcing her election loss.

Congress Ratifies Trump's Win In Peaceful Session, Unlike '21

WASHINGTON—Congress quickly and smoothly certified President-elect Donald Trump's election victory Monday, a sharp contrast to four

By Kristina Peterson,
Katy Stech Ferek
and Xavier Martinez

years earlier when a pro-Trump mob stormed the Capitol and temporarily halted the confirmation of President Biden's win.

Unlike in 2021, when the proceedings stretched out over two days, no objections

were raised. No angry crowd gathered and no lawmakers were evacuated. The proceedings wrapped up in well under an hour. But tensions over the violence of that day, which led to Trump's second impeachment, continued to simmer.

Lawmakers went ahead with their duties despite a snowstorm that hit Washington and closed schools and many businesses. Federal law requires Congress to convene for a joint session on Jan. 6

after a presidential election to count and ratify the 538 Electoral College votes certified

by the 50 states and District of Columbia.

Shortly before 1 p.m., Vice President Kamala Harris, the Democratic presidential nominee, walked onto the House floor in her role as president of the Senate, charged Monday with presiding over the certification of the election she lost. As senators poured in and greeted House colleagues, the din of the packed chamber rose to a loud buzz.

Congressional pages brought in the states' election certificates in leather boxes and staffers sliced through the

envelopes with letter openers. Lawmakers read out the results of each state's election one by one, affirming that they were accurate.

Harris, standing next to House Speaker Mike Johnson (R., La.), gave the final result: "The votes for president of the United States are as follows. Donald J. Trump of the state of Florida has received 312 votes. Kamala D. Harris... of the state of California has

Please turn to page A4

◆ **Trump seeks to cancel sentencing**..... A4

Musk Rattles Politics In Europe With Posts

By MAX COLCHESTER
AND BERTRAND BENOIT

Elon Musk is throwing grenades into Europe's political mainstream over issues from immigration to free speech, creating a dilemma for governments as they try to respond to the tech billionaire and key adviser to the incoming Trump administration.

Musk has weighed in with incendiary posts on European politics, including supporting a far-right party ahead of an election in Germany, accusing the U.K.'s prime minister of being complicit in rape, denouncing judges in Italy and slamming the European Commission.

The posts from the world's richest man has morphed into a diplomatic headache, and caught several mainstream Eu-

ropean political parties on the back foot. Weeks ahead of Donald Trump's inauguration, many European leaders have been wary of publicly calling out Musk, worried it would damage relations with Trump and prod the tech entrepreneur to double down on his attacks.

But the repeated posts to his 210 million followers are setting the news agenda in several of those countries, making it impossible to ignore. Europe's unpopular leaders worry that Musk could use X to mobilize disenchanted voters as weak economic growth erodes trust in mainstream politics and stoked political instability.

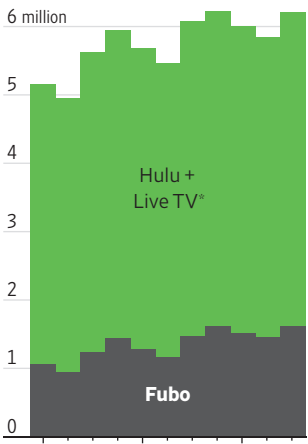
"Ten years ago if someone had told us the owner of one of the world's biggest social-

Please turn to page A7

Disney, Fubo Strike a Deal

Disney is combining its Hulu + Live TV streaming service with sports-focused FuboTV. **B1**

Subscribers in North America, quarterly



*Disney's latest fiscal quarter ended Sept. 28
Sources: Walt Disney; FuboTV

Canada's Trudeau Plans to Step Down

By VIPAL MONGA
AND PAUL VIEIRA

OTTAWA—Prime Minister Justin Trudeau on Monday said he would resign, making him the latest global progressive leader to fall from power and leaving Canada rudderless as it prepares to contend with President-elect Donald Trump's threats to upend free trade in North America.

Trudeau's resignation caps a decadelong political career during which the 53-year-old rose to global political stardom as a young, handsome and unabashed progressive whose appeal faded over time, until he became so unpopular that his Liberal Party forced him to step down before elections that must happen no



Justin Trudeau on Monday

later than October.

Trudeau said he would stay on until the party picks a new leader, a process that could take months and draw from the ranks of critics who pushed him out. The Liberal Party trails badly in the polls to the

Please turn to page A8

Taxidermist's Reputation Is Mounting

* * *
A-listers in need of decor call
Amber Maykut

By LIZA WEISSTUCH

David Burtka got the call just before Thanksgiving. After almost three years of waiting, he was getting a unicorn.

It was actually a miniature white horse that taxidermist Amber Maykut found for him at an auction house in England. She'll fix up the vintage piece and replace the decorative horn. It will go on a wall—above the boar and beside the wildebeest—at the Hamptons home that the chef and actor owns with his husband, television and Broadway star Neil Patrick Harris.

"Amber uses so many dif-

Please turn to page A12

Concerns Grow Over Stress of Military Life

Two acts of New Year's violence are stark reminder of a vexing issue

The two men had vastly different military careers that seemed unlikely to intersect. Army Master Sgt. Matthew Livelsberger was an elite spe-

By Vera Bergengruen,
Nancy A. Youssef and
Tawnell D. Hobbs

cial forces soldier who repeatedly deployed to the front lines from Africa to Afghanistan, while Army Staff Sgt. Shamsud-Din Jabbar spent years quietly supporting troops through administrative work.

Their stories overlapped in two shocking acts in the early hours of 2025, with an exploded Tesla Cybertruck in Las Vegas, in what authorities have determined was a

suicide, and a terrorist attack that killed 14 in New Orleans. The two episodes have become stark reminders of one of the most persistent and vexing threats facing the U.S. military: a tragic turn toward violence within the ranks, whether from extremist radicalization or mental-health struggles.

Military experts and veterans say that while Jabbar and Livelsberger's actions aren't representative of the men and women who serve, the struggles and pressures that haunted them are all too common. The Department of Defense has acknowledged for years that too many of its service members have fallen sway to extremist ideologies

Please turn to page A10

Jobless Find It Harder To Get New Work

More time is spent seeking a position, with the pain mostly in white-collar sectors

By MATT GROSSMAN
AND JASMINE LI

The U.S. economy has added more than two million jobs over the past year. But more people who are out of work are having a hard time getting back in.

As of November, more than seven million Americans were unemployed, meaning they didn't have work and were trying to find it. More than 1.6 million of those jobless workers had been job hunting for at least six months, according to the Labor Department. The number of people searching for that long is up more than 50% since the end of 2022.

On average, it now takes people about six months to find a job, about a month longer than it did during the postpandemic hiring boom in early 2023, according to the Labor Department. The pain is largely in high-paying white-collar jobs, including in tech, law and media, where businesses grew fast when the economy reopened from the pandemic but now have less need for new hires.

A labor market that looks healthy in the headlines is, under the surface, weaker than it seems. The unemployment rate, at 4.2%, remains well below the average during the de-

Please turn to page A5

Agentforce What AI Was Meant to Be